

CYBORG NEWS

What's *News*

In brief

Mental health fine-tuning Listing offers no findings or data to report.

AI health misinformation videos Listing offers no results or methods to report.

Emotive voice assistants Listing offers no evaluation or detail to report.

Digital driving license Listing offers no comparison data to report.

AI persuasion literacy Listing offers no experiment detail to report.

Also noted

Business intelligence agents Listing offers no benchmark scores to report.

Older adults health stories Listing offers no study outcomes to report.

Human-AI collaboration costs Listing offers no evidence beyond title to report.

LLM judges bias Listing offers no measurements to report.

ChatGPT student cognition Listing offers no classroom data to report.

COPYRIGHT

Microsoft Scientist Calls News Scraping Historic Labor Theft

An unsealed summary judgment motion from plaintiffs led by The New York Times cites internal warnings about substitution, traffic losses and verbatim outputs.



UNSEALED A federal courthouse with stone steps and columns. The Times-led plaintiffs ask the court to rule that chatbot outputs with extensive verbatim overlap infringe copyright.
W_LEMAY · CC BY-SA 2.0

An unsealed motion for summary judgment from news plaintiffs led by The New York Times presents internal Microsoft and OpenAI documents that describe training AI on news content as theft that threatens publishers and weakens fair use claims. Microsoft Director of Applied Science Brent Hecht called scraping news for AI training “largest theft of labor in human history” and “an astonishing theft of unprecedented

proportions”. ChatGPT head Nick Turley wrote that publishers faced an “existential threat” from products that substitute for news providers.

“largest theft of labor in human history”
BRENT HECHT, MICROSOFT

One Microsoft document described a “doom loop” that will hurt model performance and the web at

the same time, warning that an end product threatened the economic foundations of its essential suppliers. Microsoft recorded 83 to 93 percent drops in click through rates for some news plaintiffs and 51 to 94 percent drops for others. OpenAI staff agreed users will not click through when chatbots supply answers directly.

Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella testified under oath that AI companies should not violate news sites terms

of use by dodging paywalls and described chatbots as substitutes that keep users from visiting sources. An OpenAI staffer told President Greg Brockman about a hack to get around the NYT payroll, and Brockman replied “Ah, nice”. News groups tested chatbot outputs by requesting summaries, bullet points and bias ratings and found excerpts reproduced verbatim.

COURTS

Ninth Circuit Rejects DMCA Claim Against AI

Anonymous Github contributors said model output copied their code without copyright notices.

The U.S. Court of Appeals for the Ninth Circuit rejected a claim that makers of large language models violated Section 1202 of the Digital Millennium Copyright Act by training on code without copyright management information. Anonymous Github contributors sued Open AI and Microsoft over training data taken from Github. The court held that creating a new work without such information is different from removing it from an existing work.

Section 1202 prohibits intentional removal of copyright management information such as an author name or copyright notice. The plaintiffs alleged output code resembled their code but lacked that information. The court said absence of information in a new work does not by itself prove unlawful removal. Copyright infringement claims remain available where a model reproduces protected code. Contract claims against the companies also remain in play.

The decision limits a theory that could have exposed lawful users to costly suits.

CHILD SAFETY

EU proposal gates social media behind age checks

Phased accounts for teenagers and safety rules for AI and games would expand verification to all users.

The EU Commission has proposed a law that would place social media and AI systems behind age gates. The draft sets phased access for young people and requires verification that critics say would reduce privacy for all users. The Electronic Frontier Foundation says the measure trades safety for surveillance infrastructure. Platforms with personalized recommender systems or uninterrupted content consumption would face the strictest tiers. Children under 13 would have no service accounts. Teenagers from 13 to 15 would have restricted accounts under tight parental supervision. Teenagers from 15 to 18 would have autonomous accounts in a safe by design environment. Full online

access would remain reserved for adults.

The access delay would rely on the EU age verification scheme. Parents would set up accounts for teenagers and prove parental status. That adds a second layer of identity checks. Existing accounts could avoid checks only if a provider can show with high degree of confidence that the user is above the threshold. The standard for that confidence remains vaguely specified.

“However they’re designed, age gates undermine civil liberties, reduce safety, and create barriers to internet entry, often at the expense of marginalized groups.”

CHRISTOPH SCHMON,
ELECTRONIC FRONTIER
FOUNDATION

A second pillar called safety by design would cover social media, video sharing, online games, AI companions, chatbots and app stores. Providers would make child safe design the default and relax rules only after age assurance shows the user is an adult.

INDUSTRY

Muse Tops ChatGPT in Early iOS Downloads

Apptopia puts Muse at 1.8 million iOS downloads against 1.3 million for ChatGPT in the United States and Canada during the first 12 days.

Estimates from Apptopia show the Muse app from Meta recorded 1.8 million iOS downloads in the United States and Canada during its first 12 days on the market, compared with 1.3 million for ChatGPT over the same period after its debut.

The comparison covers iOS in the United States and Canada only. ChatGPT launched globally on iOS only. Muse launched in the United States and Canada on iOS and Android. Apptopia limited the comparison to the same stores and markets to align the figures. Total installs of Muse reached 2.8 million globally in the first 12 days.

Daily active users in the United States also favor Muse. Apptopia reports 642,000 daily users for Muse against 231,000 for ChatGPT at the same point after

launch. On iOS alone, Apptopia reports 359,000 daily active users in the United States, still above the ChatGPT figure for that period. Muse rose from No. 2 to No. 1 on the United States App Store after launch, ahead of ChatGPT, according to Business Insider. Appfigures said Muse had crossed 1 million downloads at that time.

Apptopia cautions that its figures are third party estimates without direct access to internal figures from Meta. Meta has not shared public figures related to early adoption of Muse. The report notes overlap with existing Meta services. More than 95 percent of Muse users also use Facebook, and 63 percent also use Instagram.

RESEARCH

MIT methodologist sharpens tools to measure politics accurately

Naoki Egami studies external validity, AI measurement and campaign experiments.

Naoki Egami builds statistical tools to measure social and political phenomena with precision. The MIT political scientist specializes in methodology and external validity. His research asks whether results from one study apply in other settings. His projects include field experiments in campaigns and measurement with artificial intelligence tools. He joined the Department of Political Science as an associate professor with tenure in 2025. He teaches undergraduate and graduate classes.

Egami is also a faculty affiliate of the Statistics and Data Science Center at the Institute for Data, Systems, and Society. His work identifies mathematical problems behind empirical challenges and solves them optimally. He combines questions from political science with methods from applied statistics and computer science. The approach pairs substantive problems with technical solutions. Technical theory alone can miss interesting problems. Problem focus

alone can lead to ad-hoc solutions. “You need both perspectives,” Egami says.

Field experiments in active campaigns illustrate the problem. Politicians sometimes grant researchers access to campaigns they expect to win. Politicians know they can win in those settings. Voter behavior in those lopsided races can differ from behavior in competitive districts. Findings from lopsided races may not transfer to battlefield races. Egami scrutinizes such differences in context. Statistics considers similarity of populations. Political science must also account for differences in context.

“You find out the underlying mathematical problems behind the empirical challenges people face, and solve them optimally.”

NAOKI EGAMI, MIT

Before the current artificial intelligence

interest, Egami studied accuracy when AI tools enter studies. He asks how accurate the tools are and how researchers can account for their tendencies. The work helped build a broad portfolio and win awards. He retains interest in basic questions about politics. He starts new research agendas every three to four years to learn new topics. Motivation grows with new topics.

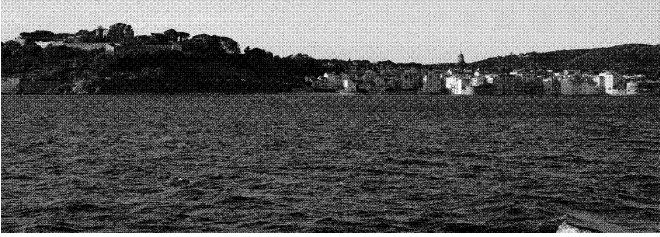
Egami grew up in Tokyo and attended the University of Tokyo. He was good at math and physics and liked political philosophy. He attended a workshop about U.S. graduate school with 200 people. A doctoral student panelist found him after the session. She invited him to a seminar the following week. The room held 20 people, including 19 professors. Kosuke Imai spoke about statistics in social science.

Egami spent a year as an exchange student at the University of Michigan and received his BA. He earned his PhD from Princeton University in 2020.

SURVEILLANCE

Boston Drops Flock After Nationwide Data Sharing

A three-day pilot error exposed plate records, yet the city started trials with two other vendors.



ABANDONED A surveillance camera watches a city street from a pole. Boston ended its Flock license-plate trial after a sharing error.

STEPHANE LESBATS (IFREMER, PÔLE IMAGES, CENTRE BRETAGNE - ZI DE LA POINTE DU DIABLE - CS 10070 - 29280 PLOUZANÉ, FRANCE) STEPHANE LESBATS (IFREMER, PÔLE IMAGES, CENTRE BRETAGNE - ZI DE LA POINTE DU DIABLE - CS 10070 - 29280 PLOUZANÉ, FRANCE) · CC BY 4.0

BOSTON —Boston ended its trial of Flock Safety license plate cameras after the company shared department data with law enforcement agencies across the country. The sharing violated a contract that limited access to trained Boston Police Department personnel. Mayor Michelle Wu confirmed the decision last week.

The department deployed about 45 automated license plate reader cameras from April to September last year. Within three days, officers learned outside agencies could view plate and vehicle records through a nationwide lookup feature. The company had enabled the feature in error after confirming sharing settings were off. The department disabled direct access and

required written requests for the rest of the trial.

The annual surveillance technology report covering 2025 did not state how many agencies viewed the records. The city requires vendors to block sharing and erase recordings after 30 days unless police retain video for legal or investigative purposes. The department began a trial with Motorola in February 2026 and a third trial with Axon in June 2026.

READS

MIT Reads is shifting its focus to fiction and memoir as it marks its 10-year anniversary.

BOSTON

Boston abandoned Flock Safety license-plate reader cameras after nationwide data sharing in violation of a contract provision.

PAPER SIZES

SIZES AND FILING DATES FROM ARXIV LISTINGS.

PAPER	SIZE	FILED
Mental Health Support	403 KB	17 Sep 2026
Women Health Videos	3,344 KB	16 Sep 2026
Voice Assistants	529 KB	14 Sep 2026
BI-Agent and BI-Bench	5,289 KB	16 Sep 2026
Peer Health Stories	6,527 KB	17 Sep 2026
AI Literacy	277 KB	17 Sep 2026
LLM-as-Judge Panels	68 KB	15 Sep 2026
Programming Cognition	2,851 KB	18 Sep 2026
LumiNote VR Lighting	23,043 KB	15 Sep 2026
Designer-RSI	21,548 KB	18 Sep 2026
Algorithmic Collusion	312 KB	17 Sep 2026
Data Hospital	1,340 KB	17 Sep 2026
AI Mediators	156 KB	15 Sep 2026
CareMirror Dementia	6,053 KB	15 Sep 2026
OpenClaw Delegation	210 KB	18 Sep 2026

POLITICS

AI PACs pour cash into South Dakota Senate race

Incumbent Mike Rounds leads a noncompetitive contest drawing outside money tied to AI labs and investors.

Major super PACs tied to AI labs and investors have poured close to \$1 million into the South Dakota Senate race of incumbent Republican Mike Rounds. The spending targets a noncompetitive contest with fewer than 50 days until the midterm elections in November. Recent polls show Rounds ahead of independent candidate Brian Beng after Democratic candidate Julian Beaudion dropped out last month.

Rounds has been the beneficiary this cycle of around \$600,000 in spending by outside groups. The vast majority of that figure comes from the super PAC Defend American Jobs. That group receives funding from a super PAC financed by the venture capital firm Andreessen Horowitz.

He has also received roughly \$215,000 directly from employees and super PACs affiliated with AI labs. The labs include most notably Anthropic. Other tech companies include Google and Microsoft, according to FEC filings. Rounds has so far raised more from tech groups than from donors in South Dakota.

AI executives view Rounds as a top supporter of the industry. The support could prove crucial in the next Congress when AI regulation is expected to become a top priority, according to congressional aides familiar with the matter. The spending reflects a new effort by AI labs to deploy vast war chests to shape issues on AI and the data centers that power it.

AI labs have focused on keeping allies in short supply on Capitol Hill as lawmakers react to public anxiety around AI safety concerns. On Thursday, Leading the Future announced it would put \$2 million towards a raft of Senate Republicans supportive of the AI or crypto industry. The super PAC is funded in part by OpenAI president Greg Brockman, along with investors Ben Horowitz and Marc Andreessen. The list included Rounds.

MUSE

In the US and Canada markets, Muse was downloaded more times in its first 12 days than ChatGPT was in the 12 days after its debut.

CAMPUS

MIT Reads Turns to Fiction for Tenth Anniversary

President Sally Kornbluth has selected Exhalation by Ted Chiang for fall 2026 to open the focus on fiction and memoir.

MIT Reads will mark ten years by turning to fiction and memoir. The MIT Libraries program links the shift to artificial intelligence and the need for social connection and shared humanity. President Sally Kornbluth has selected Exhalation by Ted Chiang as the fall 2026 book. The choice signals a focus on stories and their power to clarify ourselves and our place in the world.

Launched in 2016, MIT Reads was designed to foster empathy, understanding and belonging within the campus community. Each selected book is accompanied by talks by the featured author, panel discussions and small group conversations facilitated by library staff. Program leaders say the value of collective reading, reflection and discussion has never been more relevant.

MIT Libraries Director Chris Bourg links fiction to the work of building for the future. He describes reading together as a rare opportunity for individual

reflection and shared connection. The program is evolving as MIT examines AI influence on the education landscape and the social fabric of the Institute. A report from the Ad Hoc Committee on AI Use in Teaching, Learning, and Research Training urges stronger social connection and cites MIT Reads as a path forward.

“Reading together also gives us the increasingly rare opportunity for both individual reflection and shared connection.”

CHRIS BOURG, MIT LIBRARIES

Exhalation is a bestselling collection of short stories. It was named one of The New York Times best books of 2019. Chiang builds scenarios with robots, time travel and alternate universes. The stories explore identity, free will, language and the impacts of technology.

SUBMISSION DATES

SEPT 17	Mental health support generation Mohit Chandra and 5 other authors
SEPT 16	Culturally adaptive AI videos Anku Rani and 7 other authors
SEPT 14	Emotionally adaptive voice assistants Tapon Kumer Ray and 1 other author
SEPT 16	BI-Agent and BI-Bench Chuxuan Hu and 5 other authors
SEPT 17	Peer health stories and empathy Kexin Quan and 3 other authors
SEPT 17	Human-AI collaboration quality Saki Imai and 2 other authors
SEPT 16	Digital Driving License study Ahmad Ghandour
SEPT 17	AI literacy intervention Reed Orchinik and 1 other author
SEPT 15	LLM-as-judge panels David Ababio Awuni and 4 other authors
SEPT 18	Programming cognition with ChatGPT Christian Bergh and 3 other authors
SEPT 15	LumiNote VR lighting Danxuan Liang and 6 other authors
SEPT 18	Designer-RSI graphic design Hongyang Du and 3 other authors
SEPT 17	Algorithmic collusion in games Karthik Sivachandran and Rohan Paleja
SEPT 17	Data Hospital quality Lennard Scheurer and 3 other authors
SEPT 15	AI mediators in disputes James Hale and 1 other author
SEPT 15	Caregiver wellbeing system Jiayue Melissa Shi and 9 other authors
SEPT 18	Value-sensitive delegation Renkai Ma and 5 other authors